

CANDY DIALOGUE ENGINE

Live Dialogue Editing

1.1.0

Live dialogue editing is fairly straightforward.

The dialogue engine iterates through the Lines of a Block, one line at a time. Lines are never cached in advance: they are read directly from the **running_dialogue** dictionary.

As a result, if Lines are modified in the **running_dialogue** dictionary, the engine will process the modified Lines once it reaches them even if dialogue was already running when the modification occurred.

Method

There are no built-in commands specifically for modifying Lines.

You can use the §Set command, the same way you'd use it to modify any other variable.

Alternately, you can write and make your game run code to modify dialogues while they run.

Line Offset

Modifying lines that have already been processed can offset the iteration. For example, if the engine is at Line 5 in a Block, and you delete Line 3, this will make Line 6 become 5, Line 7 become 6, and so on. As a result, once Line 5 is finished processing, the engine will move to 6, which is now the old Line 7, effectively skipping the original Line 6 entirely.

The same problem can happen in reverse if you add Lines before the one currently being processed.

This is not an issue, however, if you delete or add Lines after the Line that is being processed.

Such offsetting can also confuse Transition commands if transitioning to Lines other than 0. To avoid this, you should transition to an §LM command, which will work correctly even if the Lines in a Block are offset.

Purpose

Editing dialogues in such a manner is not required to make use of any of Candy DE's features.

The option to edit dialogues is simply an incidental result of the engine's logic, which some users might find a use for.

As an example, it could be used to make your game create dialogues procedurally.

Wherever possible, instead of editing dialogues, we recommend providing variable references as Line data.

That said, if you are careful, editing dialogues as they run can be done safely and isn't complicated.